

Wharton Beach

Complete Tour Guide

Wharton Beach is a spectacular beach on the south coast of Western Australia, near Duke of Orleans Bay and approximately 85 km east of Esperance. It is famous for brilliant white sand, crystal-clear turquoise water, granite headlands and beautiful natural surroundings.

Quick Information

Feature	Details
Beach Name	Wharton Beach
Country	Australia
State	Western Australia
Nearest City	Esperance
Area	Duke of Orleans Bay
Distance from Esperance	Approximately 85 km
Travel Time	Around 1–1.5 hours
Beach Length	Approximately 4.5 km
Sand	Fine and brilliant white
Water Colour	Turquoise / blue-green
Beach Type	Sandy beach with granite headlands
Popular Activities	Swimming, surfing, fishing, photography, walking, 4WD
Best For	Nature lovers and beach travellers

Why Visit Wharton Beach?

Wharton Beach is special because of its incredible natural beauty. The combination of pure white sand and vivid turquoise water makes it look almost tropical, while the granite rocks and Southern Ocean scenery give it a unique Australian character. Main highlights include extremely white sand, crystal-clear water, granite headlands, a long spacious coastline, excellent photography opportunities, surfing, fishing and 4WD beach experiences.

How to Get There

Wharton Beach is usually visited from Esperance. A typical route is Esperance to Condingup, then Duke of Orleans Bay, and finally Wharton Beach. The journey is approximately 85 km and usually takes around 1 to 1.5 hours. A private car is the most convenient transport option.

Do You Need a 4WD?

A normal 2WD vehicle can generally reach the main access and parking area. However, a suitable 4WD is recommended if you plan to drive directly on the beach sand. When driving on sand, check conditions, reduce tyre pressure appropriately, stay on established tracks, avoid soft sand and carry suitable recovery equipment.

Swimming

The water at Wharton Beach is incredibly beautiful, but visitors should always respect ocean conditions. Watch for rip currents, check conditions before entering, keep children close, avoid swimming alone and follow warning signs. Marine wildlife warnings should also be checked before swimming. Never judge swimming safety only by how calm the water looks.

Surfing

Wharton Beach can offer good surfing conditions because it receives Southern Ocean swells. Conditions depend on wave size, wind direction, tide, swell and weather. Check daily conditions before entering the water.

Fishing

Fishing is popular in the wider Duke of Orleans Bay area. Rocky headlands can provide opportunities for anglers. Wear suitable shoes, watch for large waves, never turn your back on the ocean and avoid exposed rocks during rough conditions.

Best Photography Locations

The main beach viewpoint offers excellent views of turquoise water, white sand and the long coastline. Nearby granite headlands provide panoramic views and are excellent for landscape photography. Walking along the beach also provides opportunities to photograph waves, white sand, granite rocks and coastal vegetation. Late afternoon and golden hour can be particularly beautiful for photography.

Little Wharton Beach

Little Wharton Beach is another beautiful coastal destination near Wharton Beach. It can be a great addition to your trip, particularly if you have suitable transport and conditions allow safe access.

Where to Stay

The Duke of Orleans Bay area is a convenient place to stay when visiting Wharton Beach. Accommodation in the wider area may include caravan parks, camping options and holiday accommodation. Esperance is another excellent base and offers more accommodation, restaurants, supermarkets, fuel stations and tourist facilities.

Food and Supplies

Wharton Beach is relatively remote, so prepare before travelling. Bring plenty of drinking water, food and snacks, sunscreen, a hat, sunglasses, a swimsuit, a towel, first-aid supplies, a power bank and rubbish bags. For 4WD travel, consider carrying a spare tyre, tyre pressure gauge, air compressor, recovery equipment, extra water and offline maps.

Best Time to Visit

Summer, from December to February, is suitable for warm-weather beach activities. Autumn, from March to May, can offer comfortable temperatures and fewer visitors. Winter is cooler but excellent for dramatic ocean scenery and photography. Spring is a great time to explore the wider Esperance region and enjoy coastal road trips and wildflowers.

How Long Should You Spend There?

A short visit of 1 to 2 hours is enough for photographs, viewpoints and a short beach walk. A half-day visit of 3 to 5 hours allows time for relaxing, walking and photography. A full-day visit of 6 to 8 hours is ideal for exploring Wharton Beach and nearby coastal attractions.

What to Pack

Bring drinking water, food, sunscreen, a hat, sunglasses, a swimsuit, a towel, comfortable walking shoes, a first-aid kit, a phone and a power bank. For 4WD travellers, bring a tyre pressure gauge, air compressor, recovery boards, a shovel, a spare tyre, extra fuel and offline navigation.

Safety Guide

Be aware of rip currents, marine wildlife, strong winds, Southern Ocean waves, vehicles on the beach, rocky areas and strong sunlight. If conditions look unsafe, do not enter the water or attempt risky beach driving.

Responsible Tourism

Take all rubbish with you, stay on established tracks, protect dunes and vegetation, respect wildlife, follow local vehicle rules and respect Aboriginal cultural heritage.

Perfect One-Day Itinerary

7:00 AM — Leave Esperance. 8:15 AM — Arrive at Wharton Beach and visit the viewpoint. 9:00 AM — Walk along the beach. 10:00 AM — Swim or relax if conditions are safe. 12:00 PM — Picnic lunch. 1:00 PM — Explore more of the coastline. 2:30 PM — Visit Little Wharton if suitable transport and conditions allow. 4:00 PM — Return to Wharton Beach. 5:00 PM — Golden-hour photography. 6:00 PM — Begin the return journey.

Wharton Beach Rating

Sand: 5/5. Water Beauty: 5/5. Scenery: 5/5. Photography: 5/5. Surfing: 4/5. Fishing: 4/5. 4WD Experience: 5/5. Natural Beauty: 5/5. Overall Rating: 9.5/10.

Final Verdict

Wharton Beach is one of Australia's most beautiful natural beaches. Its combination of brilliant white sand, turquoise water, granite landscapes and a peaceful remote atmosphere makes it an unforgettable destination. It is especially suitable for beach lovers, photographers, road-trip travellers, surfers, anglers, nature lovers and 4WD adventurers.